

The Smart School vertical

How one platform now runs football schools alongside cricket clubs · Internal guide · September 2026

We onboarded our first football schools league (Cape Peninsula Schools Football, 2027 season) without forking the platform. One new setting does the work: every tenant now has a **sport**. A tenant with no sport set is cricket and behaves exactly as before, byte for byte. A football tenant gets school terminology, football vocabulary and a slimmer console, all driven by one code-defined profile. This guide explains what changes, what doesn't, and how to set a school tenant up.

1 · The sport profile: one switch, everything follows

When an operator creates a client, the wizard's Identity step asks for the sport. That single choice resolves a built-in profile covering wording, roles, player fields, coach options and which modules are on. Operators never assemble these pieces by hand, so a tenant can't end up half cricket, half football.

What	Cricket tenant (default)	Football / school tenant
Wording	Club, Union office, Chairperson, Exco	School, League office, Principal, School Leadership
Leadership roles	Chairperson, Secretary, Treasurer, Vice-Chair	Principal, Director of Sport, Director of Football, Director of Academics (optional) — plus Additional Members, same as before
Player profile	Batting / bowling hands, types, all-rounder, wicket-keeper	One Position pick: Goalkeeper, Right/Left Back, Centre Back, Defensive/Central/Attacking Midfielder, Winger, Striker
Coach options	CSA, Gary Kirsten · Levels 1–4	CAF, UEFA, SAFA · Levels A–D
Modules	Veterans, CQI, Compliance docs, Clearances all on	All four off — hidden in every console and refused by the server
Season label	Built-in (e.g. 2026/27)	Whatever the tenant sets (e.g. 2027)
Extras	Default doc catalogue, WhatsApp invites, tutorial videos	No docs seeded, WhatsApp off (email only), no tutorial fallback

One thing deliberately did not change: the stored keys behind the leadership roles. A Principal is saved under the same key a Chairperson always was, so notifications, contact lookups and exports keep working. Only the labels differ.

2 · Modules: hidden and enforced, never deleted

Veterans, CQI, compliance documents and clearances are now per-tenant modules. For a school tenant they disappear from both consoles (navigation, dashboards, KPI tiles, exports), and the API returns 403 on their routes, so a bookmarked deep link gets a polite dead end rather than a broken page. Progress maths adapts too: a school's journey is two phases (Affiliation, Fixtures) weighted 50/50, while cricket keeps its five phases at 20% each.

- Nothing was removed from the product. Cricket tenants see every module exactly as before.
- Each module is a flag (**module.veterans**, **module.cqi**, **module.compliance**, **module.clearances**) in the operator Features card, so any one can be switched back on for a specific tenant.
- The season label and sport can only be changed by operators — tenant admins can't flip their own vertical.

3 · Registration and transfers: the no-touch rule

Cricket uses clearances to referee player movement between clubs. Schools asked for none of that, so registration on a school tenant is deliberately simple, and deliberately safe:

- A player registering through a school's link is registered **active at that school, immediately**. No clearance, no review, no email to another school.
- If the same identity is already on another school's roster, the new registration still succeeds and carries a note ('Previously registered at ...'). The other school's roster is **never touched** — an anonymous form submission can't deactivate anyone.
- League admins resolve genuine duplicates by hand from the Players view. The note tells them where to look.
- The registration form itself drops the cricket questions: no previous-club history, no veterans question, just the football position.

4 · Fixtures and the KO Cup

Fixture generation is sport-neutral, so leagues, venues, clash detection and releases all work unchanged (football fixtures simply don't show an overs count). Two things are new:

- **Fixtures-only leagues.** A league can be marked 'Fixtures only' in the operator console. It never appears as an affiliation choice or a player's team — it exists purely to run a competition, which is how the KO Cup lives beside the age-group leagues. Only admins can attach a school to one (that's how cup entrants are set); school reps can't pick it.
- **The one-block calendar rule.** A school season that spans two terms must be set up as **one calendar block with a holiday break**, not two blocks. A round-robin can't split across blocks — two blocks will refuse to generate. The proven 2027 pattern: league rounds on Wednesdays, cup rounds on Fridays, each competition on its own calendar, final on Friday 3 September.

5 · Setting up a school tenant (operator checklist)

Step	Where	Notes
Create the client with sport = Football and its season label	Operator console → New client	The wizard shows exactly what a football client starts without; the summary repeats it before you create
Districts and age-group leagues	Client settings	e.g. North / South / East / West / CBD & Atlantic Seaboard; Boys U15/U17/U19, Girls U14/U16/U19 (A/B/C squads = team counts)
KO Cup as a fixtures-only league with its own calendar	Client settings → Leagues	Tick 'Fixtures only'; attach entrant schools from the admin club editor
Calendars: one block per season, holiday break in the middle	Fixtures & Venues	Two blocks will not fit a round robin — this is the most common setup mistake
Branding copy slots (hero, welcome, tagline)	Client settings → Copy	Worth overriding so login and hero surfaces speak schools from day one
Custom domain CNAME; check the SES sender and Cognito invite wording the schools will see	DNS sheet / AWS	Shared platform assets may still be cricket-flavoured — check before invites go out

6 · What this means for cricket tenants

Nothing. A tenant without a sport is cricket, and the cricket profile's wording is the exact text the app already used, pinned by parity tests (progress percentages, export columns and on-screen copy are compared word for word in the test suite). Existing data needed no migration, and no cricket workflow moved.

Questions or a tenant that needs different vocabulary? The profiles live in code (**src/vertical.ts** and its API twin), so a new sport is a small, reviewed change rather than configuration archaeology. Related reading: docs/guides/onboarding-a-tenant.md and the league-structures tutorial.